

Analyst compensation at nine funds: revised table

Revision of an earlier nine-firm estimate after two checks: a leader-pay and fee-waterfall review for 2016 to 2025 (founder earnings, assets, fee terms, returns, overhead, residual pool per investment professional) and a tenure sample built from search-indexed LinkedIn profile snippets, press on joiners and leavers, filings and team pages. **Bold cells changed from the original.** The ten-year column is now conditional on staying ten years; the original single figure averaged across people who mostly do not.

Firm	Avg tenure (what the sample shows)	Year 1	Avg yrs 1-5	Avg yrs 1-10, if retained	Basis
D1	3-6 yrs (no dated leavers found; current staff median ~5; firm is 8 yrs old)	\$0.4-0.7M	\$0.6-1.5M, cohort-dependent (2021-22 joiners at the bottom: no incentive fees 2022 to mid-2024)	\$1.5-4M	Modelled from AUM and fees; Sundheim's Rich List years patchy; headcount filed
Coatue	2-3 yrs junior track; 5-10 yrs seniors (leavers median 4.75, n=8; public-equity seniors median 10; 2-3-yr junior analyst program)	\$0.35-0.7M	\$0.5-1.5M	\$1.5-4M, risk-takers only	Hedge-fund fees cannot explain Laffont's figures; staff pool not derivable
TCI	~5 yrs leavers, 14+ partners (leavers median 5.25, n=10, 30% gone within 3; current partners median 14)	\$0.4-0.8M	\$0.8-2M	\$3-8M if partner; \$1-2M if not (16 equity partners averaged \$10.2M in FY to Mar 2025)	Partner pool filed for one year; Hohn's dividends filed; fees estimated
Pershing Square	6-12 yrs (leavers median 6.5, n=10; current team median 12)	\$0.4-0.8M	\$1-3M , cohort-dependent (near \$0.8-2M for 2016-18 and 2022 cohorts)	\$5-12M plus equity vesting (~\$14-20M per non-Ackman investment professional in 2023-25; ~\$7-12M ten-year average)	Audited S-1: revenue, partner comp pool, headcount, 2025 LTIP distributions
Soroban	6-8 yrs (leavers n=2 at 6.5 and 8; current analysts median ~7)	\$0.4-0.7M	\$0.8-2M	\$2-5M	Fully modelled; no founder earnings figure exists anywhere
Lone Pine	5-8 yrs (leavers median 7.5 ex-founders, n=6, 17% gone within 3; current median 5-6)	\$0.35-0.6M	\$0.6-1.5M (half-fee high-water mark since 2023 compresses recent cohorts)	\$1.5-4M, pool could support more	Modelled; AUM and fee ranges reported; most annual returns missing
Valley Forge	12+ yrs, n=1; zero investment hires found 2016-25	\$0.3-0.6M	Highly uncertain	Highly uncertain	1%/20% fees filed; founder-owned GP; team of two
Himalaya	1-2 yrs for the visible analyst seat (3 named leavers, all gone within 2 yrs, to Coatue or own funds; seat repeatedly backfilled)	\$0.3-0.6M	Highly uncertain	Highly uncertain	0/6/25 fee filed; founder owns over 75%; no carry-sharing evidence
Akre	8-12 yrs for partner-PMs (leavers median 10.3, n=3); ~6 yrs for associates who never make partner	\$0.2-0.35M	\$0.3-0.6M	\$1.5-5M if partner; \$0.5-1.2M if not (10-25% stakes from year 5-6 in a \$40-115M partner pool)	Ownership bands filed; fees and pool modelled
Fundsmith	8-15 yrs (core analysts 13-16 and still there; satellite-vehicle leavers 4-9, median 8.3, n=4)	\$0.15-0.3M	\$0.3-0.7M (all-employee average GBP 0.5-0.65M in FY2020-21)	\$1-2.5M if partner; \$0.4-1M if not (non-Smith LLP members ~GBP 2-3M)	Ten years of LLP accounts filed; Mauritius affiliate opaque

How the tenure column was built

LinkedIn itself, Google, Bing and DuckDuckGo were all unreachable from the research environment, so no profile was scraped directly. The sample is search-tool snippets of indexed LinkedIn profiles, aggregator profiles (MarketScreener, ZoomInfo, RocketReach), Companies House appointment snippets, prospectus and team-page join years, and press on departures and fund launches. Investment staff only; operations, investor relations, legal and technology excluded.

Firm	Named people	With start and end date	Leaver median tenure	Current staff median	Original claim
D1	17	0	none found	~5 yrs	3-5 yrs
Coatue	24	8	4.75 yrs (seniors 10; venture GPs 4.25)	7.5 yrs	2-4 yrs
Lone Pine	18	6	7.5 yrs ex-founders (8.5 incl.)	5-6 yrs	4-6 yrs
TCI	17	10	5.25 yrs	14 yrs (partners)	6-8 yrs
Pershing Square	21	10	6.5 yrs	12 yrs	4-6 yrs
Soroban	9	2	~7.25 yrs	~7 yrs	6-8 yrs
Valley Forge	2	0	none	~12 yrs (n=1, inferred)	long, rarely hire
Himalaya	3	3	1 yr (mean 1.3)	none named	long, rarely hire
Akre	8	3	10.3 yrs (partner-PMs)	7 yrs	8-12 yrs
Fundsmith	13	4	8.3 yrs	13 yrs	6-10 yrs

Biases: press over-samples senior people who leave to launch funds, which inflates leaver tenure; junior quiet exits are nearly invisible, especially at D1 and Coatue; current-staff tenures are right-censored; aggregator dates are year-level and sometimes stale or conflicting; several key exits (Lone Pine's 2026 wave, Granat, Pershing's Feng, Fundsmith's Barnard) fall just outside 2016 to 2025.

What changed and why

- **Year-1 rows survive everywhere.** Nudged up at D1 and Coatue and down at TCI, within the evidence. No filed source reports a first-year analyst's pay at any of the nine firms.
- **Ten-year rows were too low by three to five times** at the four firms with real disclosure (Pershing Square, TCI, Akre, Fundsmith) for anyone who makes partner, and too high for the majority who leave earlier. Splitting the cell into "if partner / if not" fixes both errors.
- **Tenure was wrong in both directions.** Pershing Square and Fundsmith were understated by about half; Himalaya's one visible analyst seat turns over every one to two years; Coatue's figure is right for the junior track but not for the firm.
- **Leader pay cannot be subtracted from fees.** Rich List figures include gains on the founder's own capital. Chris Hohn was credited with \$4.9B for 2025 against an \$81.6M dividend from TCI's UK entity; about half of Bill Ackman's \$1.4B for 2020 was the mark on his own PSH shares. Where a payment is filed it is a floor on the founder's take; the Rich List is a ceiling.
- **What actually constrains analyst pay is not pool size.** At D1, Coatue, Valley Forge and Himalaya the management fee alone funds the claimed ladder two to eight times over. Realised pay is set by high-water-mark cycles (no incentive fees at D1 from 2022 to mid-2024, at Pershing in 2016-18 and 2022, half-fee at Lone Pine from 2023) and by the founder's structural profit share.

Anchors behind the revisions

- **Pershing Square S-1** (April 2026 IPO): revenue \$512.7M, \$455.5M and \$762.5M for 2023 to 2025; profit-sharing partner compensation \$339.1M (2024) and \$459.1M (2025) across 8 to 9 investment professionals; Ackman owns 51.5% of the comp vehicle; 2025 LTIP distributions of \$139.7M (Ackman), \$28.3M (Israel), \$11.4M (Hakim).
- **TCI** accounts to March 2025 as reported in the press: 16 equity partners averaged GBP 7.6M (\$10.2M) in a year the fund returned 15%; Hohn's dividend \$81.6M. Institutional Investor credited him with \$4.9B for 2025.

- **Fundsmith** LLP accounts FY2017 to FY2025: Smith's largest-member share rose from GBP 1.6M to GBP 36.4M and fell to GBP 23.3M; other members averaged roughly GBP 2.7M; two-thirds of turnover is paid to a Mauritius affiliate that publishes nothing.
- **Akre** Form ADV ownership bands: two analysts hired in 2019 and about 2021 became 10 to 25% owners in January 2025.
- **Himalaya**: three findable analysts (2017-19, 2020-21, 2021-22) each left within two years, to Coatue or to launch funds.

Caveats

Every figure comes from search-result excerpts of press coverage of filings, not from the filed documents themselves, because Companies House, SEC EDGAR and most news sites were unreachable from the research environment. No article, survey or filing reports analyst-level pay at any of the nine firms for any year 2016 to 2025; every analyst figure is an affordability bound, a filed partner average, or an anonymous forum anecdote. Numbers in US dollars unless marked GBP; sterling converted at approximate annual average rates. Full workings, sources and the per-firm fee waterfalls are in the accompanying report "Fund leader pay and analyst pool".